Akamai Technologies, Inc.

Large Anthropic Deal Affirms Differentiation of Platform and Ability to Drive Favorable Economics on Capacity; Raise PT to $167

Neutral

AKAM, AKAM US
Price (24 Sep 26):$110.41
▲**Price Target (Dec-27):$167.00**
Prior (Dec-27):$158.00

Akamai announced the signing of the largest contract in the company's history, an $11.6B multi-year agreement with Anthropic to support its growing CPU workload demands, bringing its cumulative committed capacity deals signed in 2026 to $14.4B. The agreement materially increases visibility into its CIS growth over a multi-year period and the favorable economics of the deal further validates the relevance of its distributed infrastructure for AI workloads, although the timing of capital deployment relative to revenue does imply that Akamai will likely have to raise capital in 2027. The new engagement is entirely CPU-focused and serves to highlight the breadth of the opportunity, which extends beyond GPU compute. The favorable economics reinforce the differentiation of Akamai's software management stack to deliver high-performance, low-latency compute, leading to economics on average of $22M / MW surpassing even the economics currently associated with long-term GPU compute deals from NeoClouds. Importantly, with the announcement of the $11.6B agreement already driving significantly higher CIS growth expectations in the out-year relative to our prior model, Akamai and Anthropic also have the option to expand the agreement to encompass another $9B of multi-year revenue, with considerations associated with the expansion leading us to conclude that the opportunity to convert the incremental $9B is a path of low resistance and will likely present an upside driver to our updated estimates for growth. Our preliminary math indicates that the margin profile of the agreement is quite favorable and positions Akamai well for robust operating leverage-led margin improvement once fully ramped, although there are likely to be some temporary margin headwinds while the capacity comes online. We are raising our revenue and profit forecasts materially in CIS and for the total company following the announcement, with opportunity for further upsides from the potential expansion of the contract highlighted above; the higher estimates drive a raise to our Dec-27 PT to $167; however, we remain Neutral as we look for more diversified customer drivers for demand as Anthropic now comprises 93% of the $14.4B in committed capacity contracts signed this year.

- **Significant capital deployment precedes the revenue inflection into FY28.** Management expects no revenue from the new agreement in FY26, with service initiation in late 2Q27 and revenue ramping in 2H27 to $150M-300M for FY27. Revenue is expected to ramp throughout FY28, reaching an annualized run rate of ~$1.7B by year-end and remaining steady thereafter under the take-or-pay structure, subject to delivery and service requirements. Contract-related capex totals ~$5.5B, including $1.7B in 4Q26 to secure critical components, including memory, $3.1B in FY27 and $700M in FY28. In relation to funding requirements, management cited $4.6B of cash at the last reported quarter and a $1B revolver as sources of capital, while acknowledging that it could seek additional financing. Despite an estimated favorable margin outcome on the new Anthropic contract, we anticipate temporary margin pressure during the 60-90 day ramp of new sites, with depreciation beginning

Software - Large Cap / Mid & Small Cap

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Key Changes (FYE Dec)

	Prev	Cur	Δ
Adj. EPS - 27E ($)	7.29	6.06	-17.0%

Quarterly Forecasts (FYE Dec)

Adj. EPS ($)	2025A	2026E	2027E
Q1	1.70	1.61A	1.55
Q2	1.73	1.59A	1.45
Q3	1.86	1.66	1.55
Q4	1.84	1.80	1.51
FY	7.12	6.66	6.06

Style Exposure

Quant Factors	Current %Rank	Hist %Rank (1=Top) 6M	1Y	3Y	5Y
Value	36	35	20	48	31
Growth	77	71	70	69	74
Momentum	57	32	69	30	70
Quality	51	47	45	22	40
Low Vol	35	28	24	8	9
ESGQ	16	46	30	95	25

Sources for: Style Exposure – J.P. Morgan Global Markets Strategy; all other tables are company data and J.P. Morgan estimates.

See page 8 for analyst certification and important disclosures.

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Price Performance



	YTD	1m	3m	12m
Abs	26.5%	4.5%	-7.6%	44.8%
Rel	12.3%	9.8%	-2.5%	28.4%

Company Data

Shares O/S (mn)	159
52-week range ($)	165.45-70.82
Market cap ($ mn)	17,525.37
Exchange rate	1.00
Free float (%)	97.8%
3M ADV (mn)	3.57
3M ADV ($ mn)	412.0
Volatility (90 Day)	56
Index	RUSSELL 2000
BBG ANR (Buy | Hold | Sell)	17|8|1

Key Metrics (FYE Dec)

$ in millions	FY25A	FY26E	FY27E	FY28E
Financial Estimates				
Revenue	4,208	4,484	5,382	7,048
Adj. EBIT	1,254	1,133	1,074	1,726
Adj. EBITDA	1,802	1,750	2,255	3,308
Adj. net income	1,046	1,005	943	1,439
Adj. EPS	7.12	6.66	6.06	9.06
BBG EPS	7.04	6.69	7.26	8.13
Cashflow from operations	1,519	1,600	2,273	3,197
FCFF	730	(1,838)	(2,515)	521
Margins and Growth				
Revenue Growth Y/Y (%)	5.4%	6.6%	20.0%	31.0%
EBIT margin	29.8%	25.3%	20.0%	24.5%
EBIT Growth Y/Y (%)	7.4%	(9.6%)	(5.2%)	60.7%
EBITDA margin	42.8%	39.0%	41.9%	46.9%
EBITDA Growth Y/Y (%)	7.1%	(2.9%)	28.8%	46.7%
Net margin	24.9%	22.4%	17.5%	20.4%
Adj. EPS growth	10.3%	(6.4%)	(9.0%)	49.6%
Ratios				
Adj. tax rate	18.7%	19.0%	18.9%	18.9%
Interest cover	NM	NM	NM	NM
Net debt/Equity	NM	NM	NM	NM
Net debt/EBITDA	NM	NM	NM	NM
ROE	21.2%	19.2%	15.4%	19.4%
Valuation				
FCFF yield	4.5%	(11.0%)	(14.6%)	3.0%
Dividend yield	-	-	-	-
EV/Revenue	3.6	2.8	1.8	1.5
EV/EBITDA	8.5	7.1	4.4	3.1
Adj. P/E	15.5	16.6	18.2	12.2

Summary Investment Thesis and Valuation

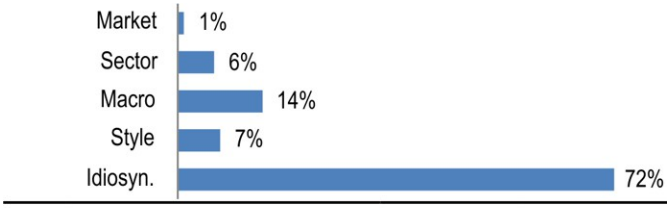
Investment Thesis

Akamai is an established content delivery network (CDN) provider undergoing a business transition to focus its efforts on its Cloud Infrastructure Services (CIS) segment, as well as its Security segment to position itself to benefit from multiple avenues of AI tailwinds. The company operates the world's largest distributed edge network, which was originally architected to serve its Delivery business, but now serves as one of the key advantages underpinning the argument for the long-term durability of Akamai's Inference Cloud service, which can handle inference requests under steep latency-sensitive requirements at scale and at attractive costs for customers. Akamai anticipates seeing 'hockey stick growth' in its CIS business beginning in F4Q26, benefiting from significant revenue recognition in relation to its large, committed capacity compute deals signed in 2026. While the company is seeing meaningful growth in its emerging Security products such as API Security & Guardicore Segmentation Solutions with broad-based AI adoption serving as an accelerant, its cloud business has yet to prove execution at scale and the AI inference-led growth vectors are still nascent in aggregate, leading us to believe that a further re-rating from current levels will be led by execution on the opportunity. We rate Akamai Neutral.

Valuation

We are raising our Dec-27 price target to $167 from $158, which is based on a ~20x CY28 EV/PF Operating Income multiple, with the target multiple now higher than the previously leveraged 17x, on account of the improved growth expectations.

Performance Drivers



Factors	6M Corr	1Y Corr
Market: MSCI US	0.01	-0.03
Sect: Technology	0.45	0.25
Ind: Software & Serv	0.24	0.20
Macro:		
Economic Surprise	0.44	0.32
Non-Energy Commodity	0.27	0.19
Credit Spread	0.11	0.11
Quant Styles:		
Quality	-0.34	-0.28
DivYld	0.05	0.09
Size	-0.02	-0.08

Source: J.P. Morgan Global Markets Strategy for Performance Drivers; company data, Bloomberg Finance L.P. and J.P. Morgan estimates for all other tables. Note: Price history may not be complete or exact.

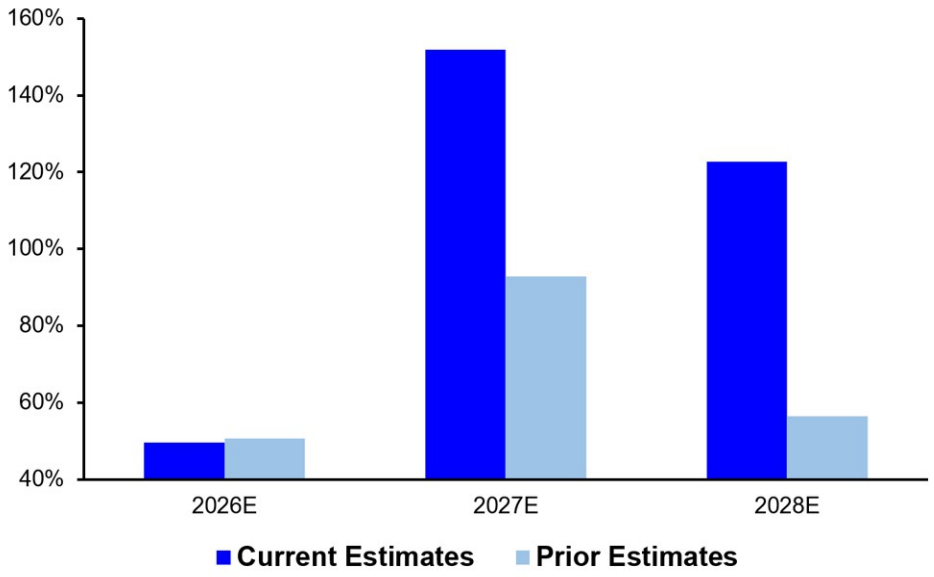
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when equipment enters service substantially in line with revenue.

- **CPU power efficiency and reuse of the existing platform support attractive profitability despite a lower revenue-to-capex ratio.** Including ~$2.8B of prior commitments, signed CIS TCV in 2026 now totals ~$14.4B, which management expects to generate ~$2.2B of ARR when fully ramped on 95-105 MW of power, or ~$22M of annual revenue per MW across the portfolio. Management indicated annual colocation costs of ~$3M-4M per MW, with maintenance, warranties and other overhead costs also relevant to profitability. For the new agreement, the ratio of ARR to cumulative capex is closer to 0.33x vs. the ~0.5x-1.0x management previously cited "larger deals," with the company citing differences in relation to scale and pricing relative to historical agreements, while highlighting CPU power efficiency, the seven-year term, and no contractual hardware refresh requirement.
- **Additional commitments offer meaningful upside, with warrant incentives tied to new business.** Management characterized the additional $9B opportunity as optional future business, with no dependency on milestones under the initial commitment; any expansion would require additional capex and could include CPU or GPU capacity depending on customer needs. As part of the agreement, Anthropic will receive warrants for non-voting convertible preferred stock representing up to ~7.7M common share equivalents, or ~5% of shares outstanding, at a common-equivalent exercise price of $111.33 (shares traded above $130 after hours on the announcement).
- **Updated CIS growth forecasts.** As outlined below, our updated CIS growth forecasts now incorporate 152% growth in 2027 and 123% in 2028 with the benefit of the recent agreement with Anthropic, relative to our prior forecasts for 93%/ 56% growth in 2027E/2028E.

Figure 1: Change in CIS Revenue Growth Estimates

% Change Y/Y



Source: J.P. Morgan estimates

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Investment Thesis, Valuation and Risks

Akamai Technologies, Inc. *(Neutral; Price Target: $167.00)*

Investment Thesis

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Figure 4: EV/Operating Income Valuation Analysis for Akamai

Units in millions

Price Target Math	2027E	2028E
Pro-Forma Op Inc	**1,074**	**1,726**
EV/Op Inc Multiple	23.1x	
Target EV/Op Inc Multiple		20x
Enterprise Value	**24,801**	**33,662**
Net Debt	7,621	7,163
Equity Value	**17,179**	**26,500**
Shares Outstanding	156	159
Implied Target Share Price		**$ 167.00**
Implied Upside		*51%*
Current Share Price	$ 110.41	$ 110.41
Memo:		
Implied EV/Revenue	4.6x	4.8x
Implied EV/EBITDA	11.0x	10.2x

Source: Company filings, J.P. Morgan, Bloomberg Finance L.P. as of 9/24/26

Risks to Rating and Price Target

Industry Upside Risks

Market pricing for AI compute could remain stronger than expected. Continued supply constraints and robust demand for GPU capacity could support stronger-than-expected market pricing for compute. Greater-than-expected strength in pricing, particularly for on-demand inference workloads, could drive upside to our revenue and margin estimates.

Industry Downside Risks

Inference workloads could remain concentrated in centralized clouds. Improvements in active control, GPU observability, and traffic-routing solutions could allow centralized cloud providers to sufficiently address latency requirements for a broader range of inference workloads. Slower-than-expected migration of runtime-sensitive workloads toward

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distributed compute networks could limit demand for Akamai's differentiated architecture.

Company Upside Risks

Akamai could prove the criticality of its distributed architecture earlier than expected. Akamai's global edge network allows compute workloads to run closer to end users and stored data, reducing latency and other incremental costs associated with centralized compute clusters. Customer recognition of these benefits on a faster timeline than we currently anticipate could drive stronger demand, improved deal economics, and upside to our CIS estimates.

On-demand inference revenue could grow faster than expected. Akamai expects on-demand consumption to increase as a percentage of CIS revenue in the medium- to long-term as "real-world" enterprise AI use cases move into production. A faster-than-expected mix shift toward on-demand inference and monetization of attractive market pricing for GPU rentals could drive upside to our CIS revenue estimates.

Company Downside Risks

Slower-than-expected execution on committed capacity deployments. Our estimates assume a meaningful acceleration in CIS revenue beginning in F4Q26 as revenue recognition commences for large committed capacity agreements. Delays in GPU delivery, data center capacity coming online, or customer deployments in F4Q26 and beyond could push revenue recognition beyond our expectations and lead to downside to our estimates.

Weaker-than-expected CIS margins. Our valuation assumes Akamai delivers compute capacity at or above the cash gross margin and pro forma operating margin expectations provided by management. Lower utilization, weaker pricing, or higher-than-expected infrastructure costs could result in margins below our estimates and limit further multiple expansion.

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Akamai Technologies, Inc.: Summary of Financials

Income Statement - Annual	FY24A	FY25A	FY26E	FY27E	FY28E
Revenue	**3,991**	**4,208**	**4,484**	**5,382**	**7,048**
COGS	(1,560)	(1,650)	(1,925)	(2,782)	(3,682)
Gross profit	**2,432**	**2,558**	**2,559**	**2,559**	**2,600**
SG&A	(988)	(1,011)	(1,097)	(1,184)	(1,240)
Adj. EBITDA	**1,682**	**1,802**	**1,750**	**2,255**	**3,308**
D&A	(514)	(548)	(617)	(1,181)	(1,582)
Adj. EBIT	**1,167**	**1,254**	**1,133**	**1,074**	**1,726**
Net Interest	73	40	112	100	60
Adj. PBT	**1,232**	**1,287**	**1,240**	**1,162**	**1,774**
Tax	(82)	(150)	(84)	(52)	(116)
Minority Interest	-	-	-	-	-
Adj. Net Income	**996**	**1,046**	**1,005**	**943**	**1,439**
Reported EPS	3.27	3.07	2.83	1.68	3.69
Adj. EPS	**6.45**	**7.12**	**6.66**	**6.06**	**9.06**
DPS	**-**	**-**	**-**	**-**	**-**
Payout ratio	-	-	-	-	-
Shares outstanding	154	147	151	156	159

Balance Sheet & Cash Flow Statement	FY24A	FY25A	FY26E	FY27E	FY28E
Cash and cash equivalents	518	930	559	830	1,289
Accounts receivable	728	794	878	1,095	1,401
Inventories	0	0	0	0	0
Other current assets	1,333	563	1,081	1,212	1,359
Current assets	**2,578**	**2,287**	**2,519**	**3,137**	**4,048**
PP&E	1,995	2,333	5,483	9,147	9,673
LT investments	276	733	1,261	1,261	1,261
Other non current assets	5,520	6,126	6,476	6,524	6,575
Total assets	**10,369**	**11,480**	**15,739**	**20,069**	**21,557**
Short term borrowings	1,149	0	1,706	1,706	1,706
Payables	130	125	151	190	222
Other short term liabilities	812	842	900	1,048	1,193
Current liabilities	**2,091**	**968**	**2,757**	**2,944**	**3,121**
Long-term debt	2,397	4,105	5,857	8,707	8,707
Other long term liabilities	1,002	1,429	1,627	1,644	1,663
Total liabilities	**5,490**	**6,502**	**10,241**	**13,295**	**13,491**
Shareholders' equity	4,878	4,977	5,498	6,774	8,065
Minority interests	0	0	0	0	0
Total liabilities & equity	**10,369**	**11,480**	**15,739**	**20,069**	**21,557**
BVPS	**31.61**	**33.85**	**36.43**	**43.54**	**50.81**
y/y Growth	*6.4%*	*7.1%*	*7.6%*	*19.5%*	*16.7%*
Net debt/(cash)	(1,674)	(2,186)	(5,042)	(7,621)	(7,163)
Cash flow from operating activities	**1,519**	**1,519**	**1,600**	**2,273**	**3,197**
o/w Depreciation & amortization	648	709	788	1,507	2,019
o/w Changes in working capital	(34)	(173)	(196)	(192)	(306)
Cash flow from investing activities	**(799)**	**(541)**	**(4,456)**	**(4,852)**	**(2,739)**
o/w Capital expenditure	(685)	(820)	(3,475)	(4,852)	(2,739)
as % of sales	*17.2%*	*19.5%*	*77.5%*	*90.2%*	*38.9%*
Cash flow from financing activities	**(680)**	**(588)**	**2,485**	**2,850**	**0**
o/w Dividends paid	-	-	-	-	-
o/w Net debt issued/(repaid)	0	883	4,110	2,850	0
Net change in cash	**(12,202)**	**23,387**	**208**	**271**	**459**
Adj. Free cash flow to firm	**861**	**730**	**(1,838)**	**(2,515)**	**521**
y/y Growth	*35.4%*	*(15.2%)*	*(351.8%)*	*36.8%*	*(120.7%)*

Income Statement - Quarterly	1Q26A	2Q26A	3Q26E	4Q26E
Revenue	**1,074A**	**1,100A**	**1,117**	**1,194**
COGS	(450)A	(461)A	(489)	(525)
Gross profit	**624A**	**638A**	**628**	**669**
SG&A	(263)A	(288)A	(268)	(277)
Adj. EBITDA	**427A**	**416A**	**434**	**474**
D&A	(144)A	(145)A	(158)	(170)
Adj. EBIT	**283A**	**271A**	**276**	**304**
Net Interest	9A	23A	40	41
Adj. PBT	**292A**	**293A**	**313**	**341**
Tax	(16)A	(21)A	(22)	(25)
Minority Interest	-	-	-	-
Adj. Net Income	**239A**	**236A**	**253**	**277**
Reported EPS	0.72A	0.54A	0.74	0.85
Adj. EPS	**1.61A**	**1.59A**	**1.66**	**1.80**
DPS	**-**	**-**	**-**	**-**
Payout ratio	-	-	-	-
Shares outstanding	149A	148A	153	154

Ratio Analysis	FY24A	FY25A	FY26E	FY27E	FY28E
Gross margin	60.9%	60.8%	57.1%	47.5%	36.9%
EBITDA margin	42.1%	42.8%	39.0%	41.9%	46.9%
EBIT margin	29.2%	29.8%	25.3%	20.0%	24.5%
Net profit margin	24.9%	24.9%	22.4%	17.5%	20.4%
ROE	21.0%	21.2%	19.2%	15.4%	19.4%
ROA	9.8%	9.6%	7.4%	5.3%	6.9%
ROCE	24.9%	27.4%	38.8%	174.6%	128.7%
SG&A/Sales	24.8%	24.0%	24.5%	22.0%	17.6%
Net debt/equity	NM	NM	NM	NM	NM
P/E (x)	17.1	15.5	16.6	18.2	12.2
P/BV (x)	3.5	3.3	3.0	2.5	2.2
EV/EBITDA (x)	9.4	8.5	7.1	4.4	3.1
Dividend Yield	-	-	-	-	-
Sales/Assets (x)	0.4	0.4	0.3	0.3	0.3
Interest cover (x)	NM	NM	NM	NM	NM
Operating leverage	59.4%	136.1%	(146.5%)	(26.0%)	196.2%
Revenue y/y Growth	4.7%	5.4%	6.6%	20.0%	31.0%
EBITDA y/y Growth	4.6%	7.1%	(2.9%)	28.8%	46.7%
Tax rate	19.2%	18.7%	19.0%	18.9%	18.9%
Adj. Net Income y/y Growth	3.7%	5.1%	(4.0%)	(6.2%)	52.6%
EPS y/y Growth	4.0%	10.3%	(6.4%)	(9.0%)	49.6%
DPS y/y Growth	-	-	-	-	-

Source: Company reports and J.P. Morgan estimates.
Note: $ in millions (except per-share data).Fiscal year ends Dec. o/w - out of which

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Akamai Technologies, Inc. (AKAM, AKAM US) Price Chart



Date	Rating	Price ($)	Price Target ($)
07-Nov-23	UW	108.44	78
13-Feb-24	UW	128.15	81
08-Aug-24	UW	92.64	76
21-Feb-25	UW	98.03	72
08-May-26	UW	116.69	100
07-Aug-26	UW	118.55	132
13-Aug-26	N	122.78	158

Source: Bloomberg Finance L.P. and J.P. Morgan; price data adjusted for stock splits and dividends.
Initiated coverage Jun 29, 2009. All share prices are as of market close on the previous business day.

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	Overweight (buy)	Neutral (hold)	Underweight (sell)
J.P. Morgan Global Equity Research Coverage*	53%	36%	12%
IB clients**	83%	80%	73%
JPMS Equity Research Coverage*	51%	37%	12%
IB clients**	95%	92%	87%

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****Percentage of subject companies within each of the "buy," "hold" and "sell" categories for which J.P. Morgan has provided investment banking services within the previous 12 months.**
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